BOOK II

PRELUDE I

THIS Prelude is full of the double meanings obtainable on key-board instruments by holding the notes of a melody so that they grow into sustained chords (bar 3) and, on the other hand, by allowing two separate parts to combine in a melodic sense different from that of either (as in bars 7-8 and, still more particularly, 11, where the combined sense of the parts in pairs gives the real themes).

On the clavichord and the pianoforte such writing is clearer than it is on the organ, where the sustained notes remain so full that a lower moving part can scarcely penetrate. But the pianoforte does its best for this technique only within a moderate range of tone. The player's reserve of *legato* tone-power must be enormous if he is to hope to produce a *forte* that does anything better than " stick pins into " the long notes; and he will attain any such power soonest and most permanently by resolving never to force the tone and never to leave the ear unsatisfied as to the connection between a suspension and its resolution. Very long notes should be unobtrusively renewed without scruple before they have died away; the renewal may take place simply by repeating instead of tying, or it may be done at a rhythmically odd moment when the attention is directed to a moving part. The approach of a long note can almost always be managed in a melodious swell which will justify striking the note with full tone; thus, in the extreme case of bar 3, there should be a climax of tone like a violinist's G string or a deep contralto at the end of bar 2, and the semiquavers in bar 3 (both right and left) should set in with no effect of entry, but simply as continuing the long melodic line, beginning with the same contralto tone but vanishing quickly into the depths so that the chord may be heard floating above them. If the upper E has, nevertheless, become dangerously thin before bar 4, then frankly strike it again with the A in bar 5, but let both it and the A be no louder than will match the previous chord.

With the middle of bar 5 the design begins to develop. The whole passage from bar $5\frac{1}{2}$ to bar 13 is recapitulated (with one slight change) in bars 20-28. (In its earliest version the Prelude was only 17 bars long.) The *tempo* is a deliberate eight in the bar: in the earliest versions it would have been faster, but the graceful demisemiquaver details Bach has given in its final form require the leisure of a very broad *tempo*. Compare the similar history of Prelude X. in Book I.

FUGUE I

AN early version of this Fughetta (so-called therein) bars it in $\frac{4}{4}$ instead of $\frac{2}{4}$ time. The later notation adds liveliness by increasing the number of main accents.

The answer to the Subject is accompanied by a counterpoint which continues the figures of the Subject, and is occasionally reproduced in the same position. This does not constitute a real Countersubject and does not require any emphasis.

The mordent in the second bar should be applied in all entries of the whole Subject, but not in the merely imitative Episodes of bars 14-20 and 55 to the end. It is worth practising even where difficult, as in bar 22, so as to distinguish the real entries from the Episodes. At bar 67 the Fugue reaches a climax in a spirited Coda (not found in the early versions), where the opening figure should be given with culminating emphasis though it never proceeds further with the Subject. Note Bach's favourite device of cumulative repetition in the tonic, and let the pianoforte enjoy itself in the sonorous vigour of the last eight bars.

Throughout this Fugue the treatment of all quavers as *staccato* answers excellently, except in bars 11-12, 19-22, 46, 61-67, where a singing *legato* is needed. The crotchets of the Subject should also be detached. The ∾ in bar 8 stands for a trill with turn, like that in bar 28. The shake in bar 37 stops on the fourth quaver of the bar.

A.B. 100.

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